Connor Simpson

Percussion Quartet

Buzzed

6'

2020

Mere Fly Press

Buzzed
Percussion Quartet
6 minutes
2020
Connor Simpson
Mere Fly Press (ASCAP)

Program Notes

Buzzed slows down and analyses the gestures of the sounds chosen for the piece and represents them structurally. The buzzing gesture controls the form of the piece, just as a coin rattles on a vibraphone, large attacks occur throughout the piece increasing in frequency by a constant ratio. Other sounds like rattles are represented by randomly scattered wooden attacks and the friction within an attack is represented by bowed techniques.

Instrumentation

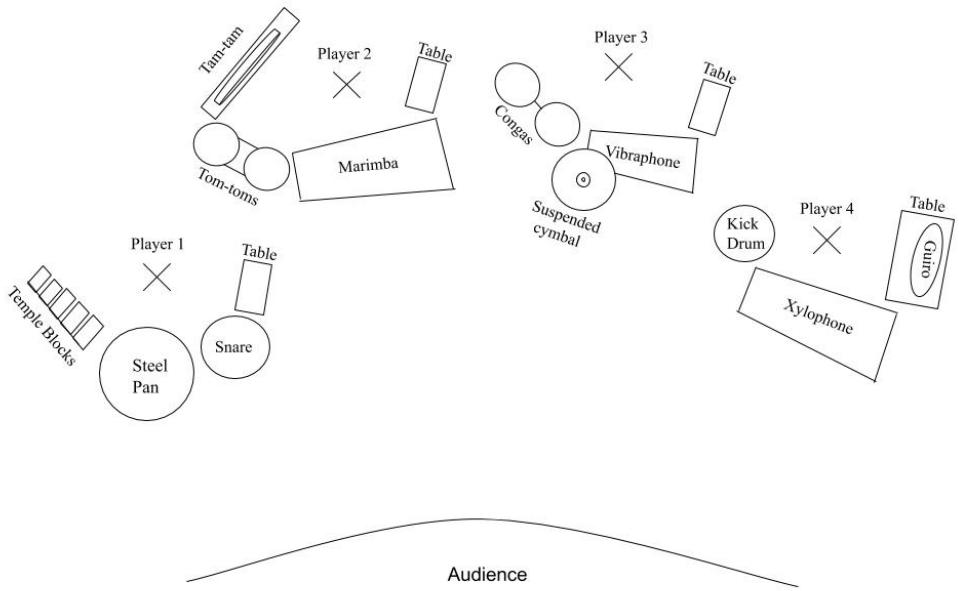
Percussion 1
Steel Pan
(if no steel pan, play steel drum part on Vibes)
Temple Blocks (coin half taped on middle tpl. bl.)
Snare (upside down, batter head on both sides)
1 Finger Cymbal
Bow

Percussion 2
Marimba
2 toms
Tam-tam (2 chopsticks and mallet tied, dangling on head)
1 Finger Cymbal
Bow

Percussion 3
Vibraphone (coin half taped on Eb 5, B5 and B6)
Suspended Cymbal (upside down, filled with coins)
Congas
1 Finger Cymbal
Bow

Percussion 4
Xylophone (coin half taped on e5)
Guiro (on table, do not pick up to play)
Kick drum (on table, played with mallets)
1 Finger Cymbal
Bow

Setup



Performance Notes

- Each percussionist is to have a stopwatch of some kind. Before the piece begins, the percussionists are to all synchronize their stopwatches exactly.
- Each system represents 15 seconds, and the performers are to estimate the timing of each sound within that system based on the position within the system unless specified otherwise according to the following line.
- Any gesture marked with a time i.e. **0:13:00** is to be played when the percussionist's stopwatch matches that time exactly.
- All quarter notes represent an individual attack whereas whole notes represent sustained notes i.e., bowing, or sustained repeated attacks i.e., rolls.
- Performers should aim not to listen to one another or to imply a sense of meter throughout the piece.
- The performers are asked to remain still while resting and look down at their instruments.

Notation

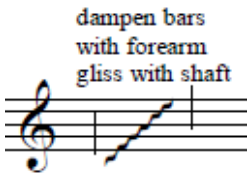
Pitched Percussion

Dead Stroke

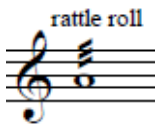
Body

(On Vibraphone, Marimba and Xylophone) Muffle key with hand by “grabbing” from above and below. Strike using other hand

(On Vibraphone, Marimba and Xylophone) Mute key by firmly placing mallet on top of key. Strike the shaft of mallet on top of the key with the other mallet.



(On Vibraphone, Marimba and Xylophone) Firmly place forearm across bars. Glissando from an indeterminate pitch to another indeterminate pitch using the shaft of the mallet.



(On Vibraphone, Marimba and Xylophone) Before the performance find a pair of two adjacent bars on the instrument such that the shaft of a mallet may be placed in between the bars and rest against a resonator. Then, roll on the designated bar.

Unpitched Percussion

Dead Stroke

Body

Rub base of mallet against key. Place end of shaft firmly on key and firmly press down on the while allowing the mallet to vibrate.

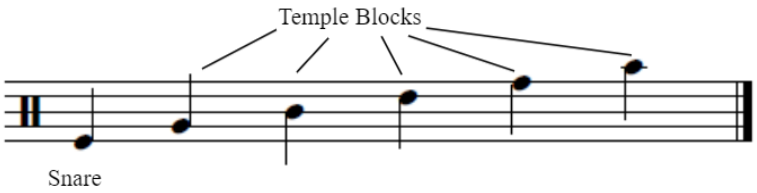
Buzz roll

finger roll

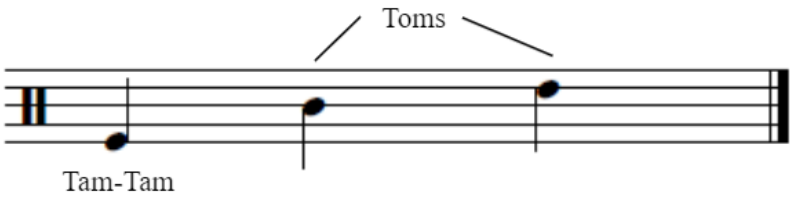
Finger roll on surface. With considerable pressure drag finger pad across surface.

Notation keys

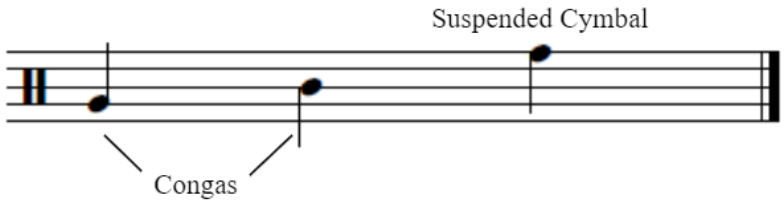
Percussion 1



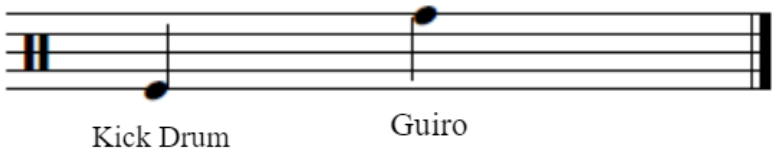
Percussion 2



Percussion 3



Percussion 4



Buzzed

Score

Connor Simpson

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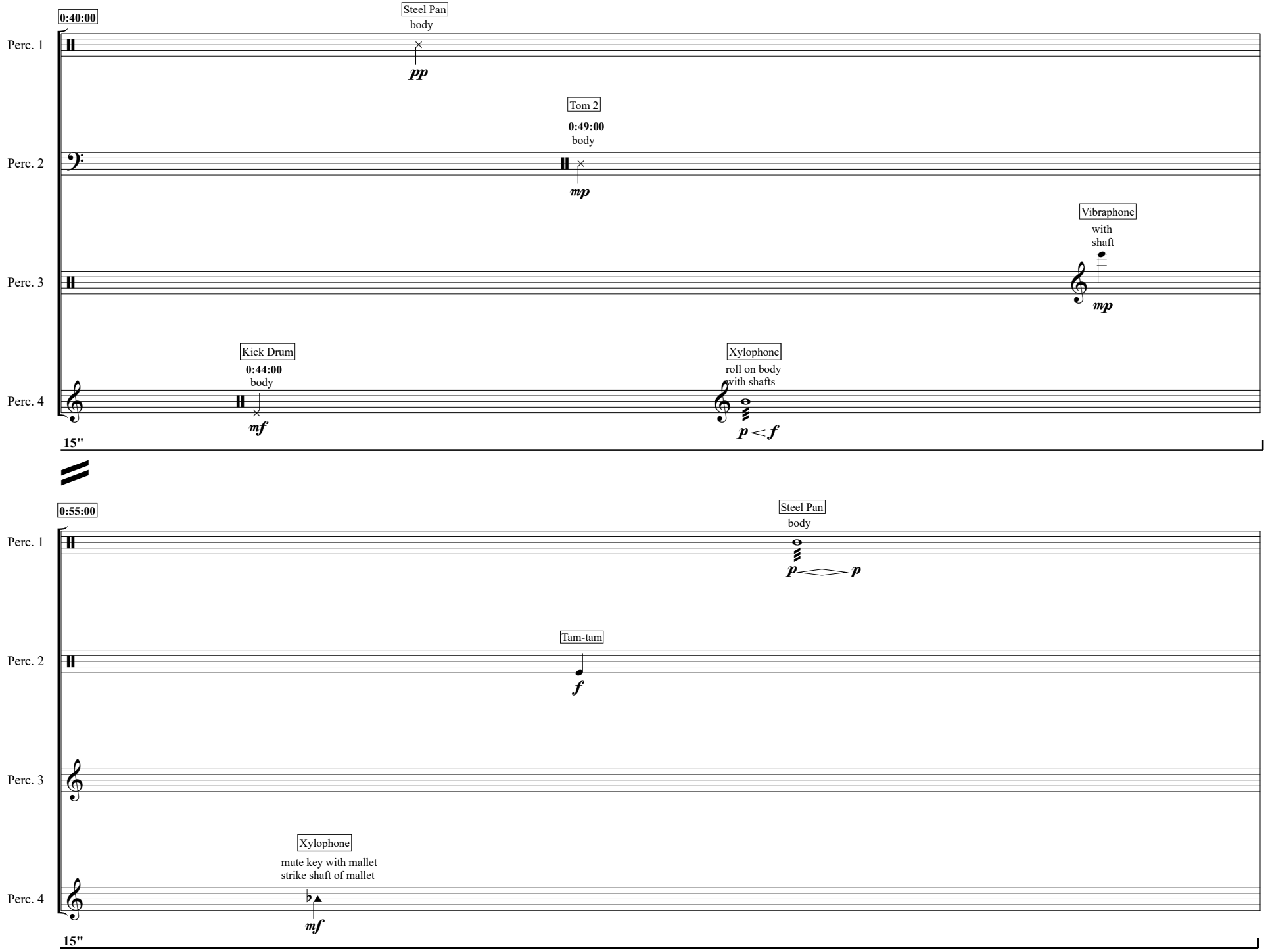
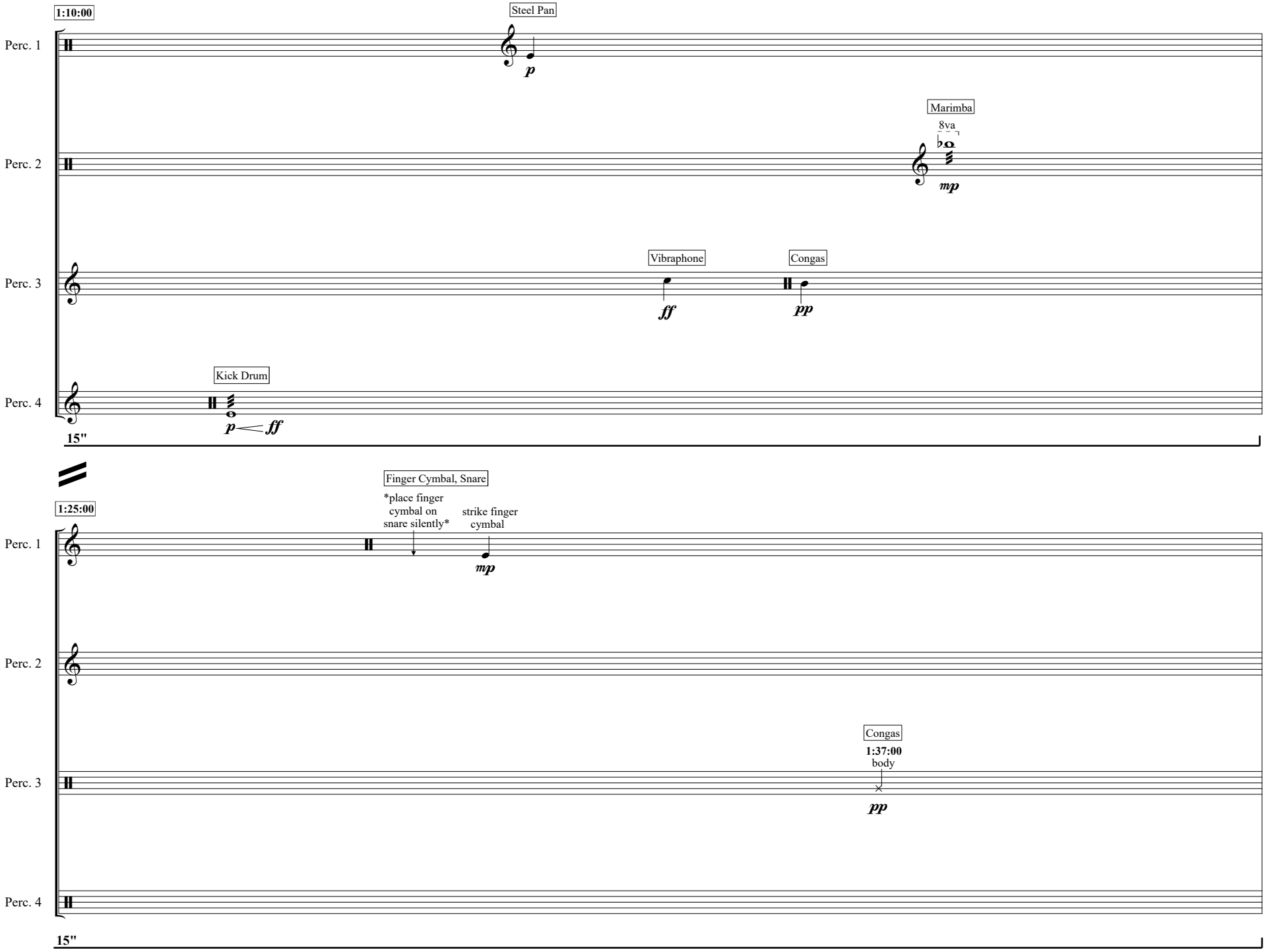
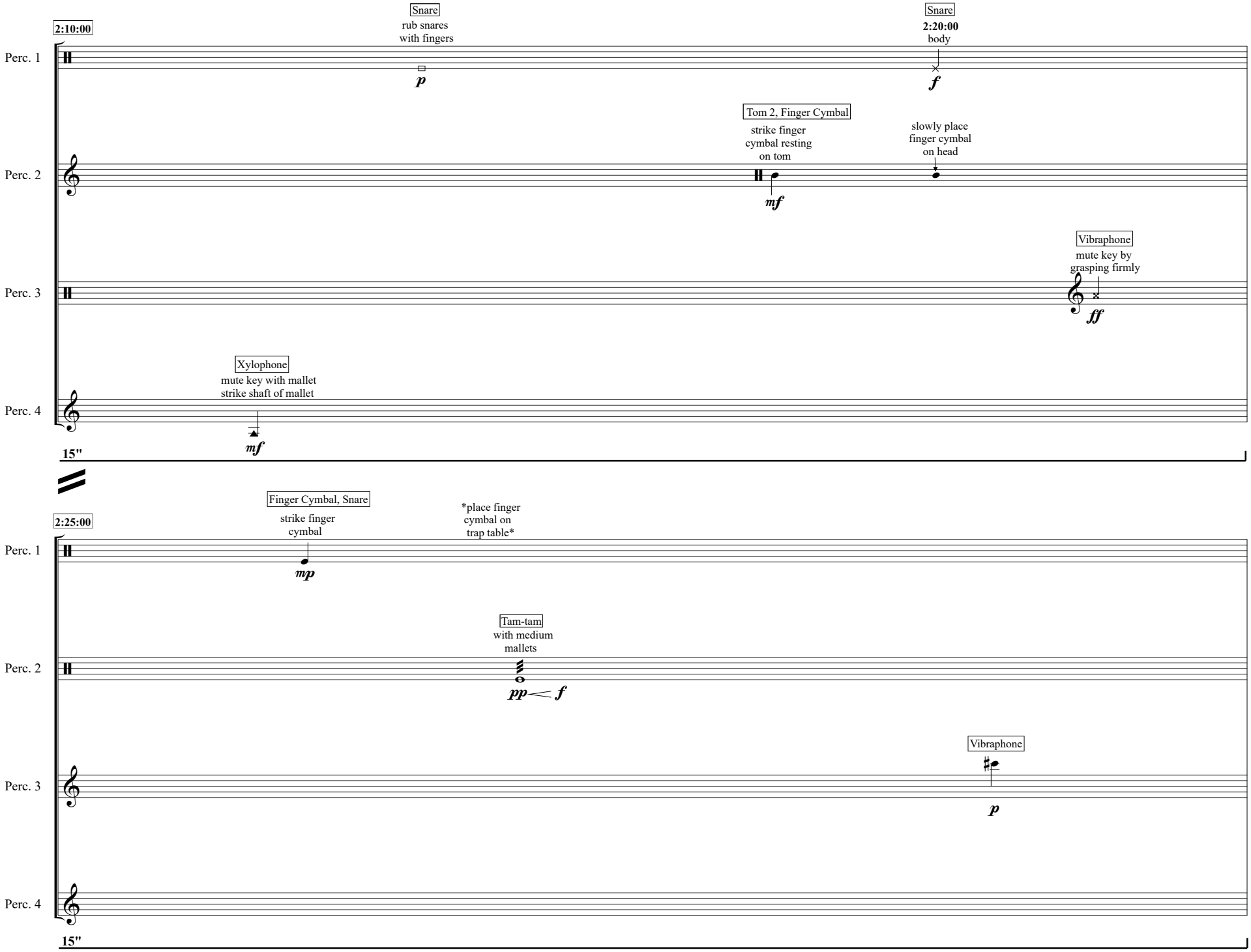
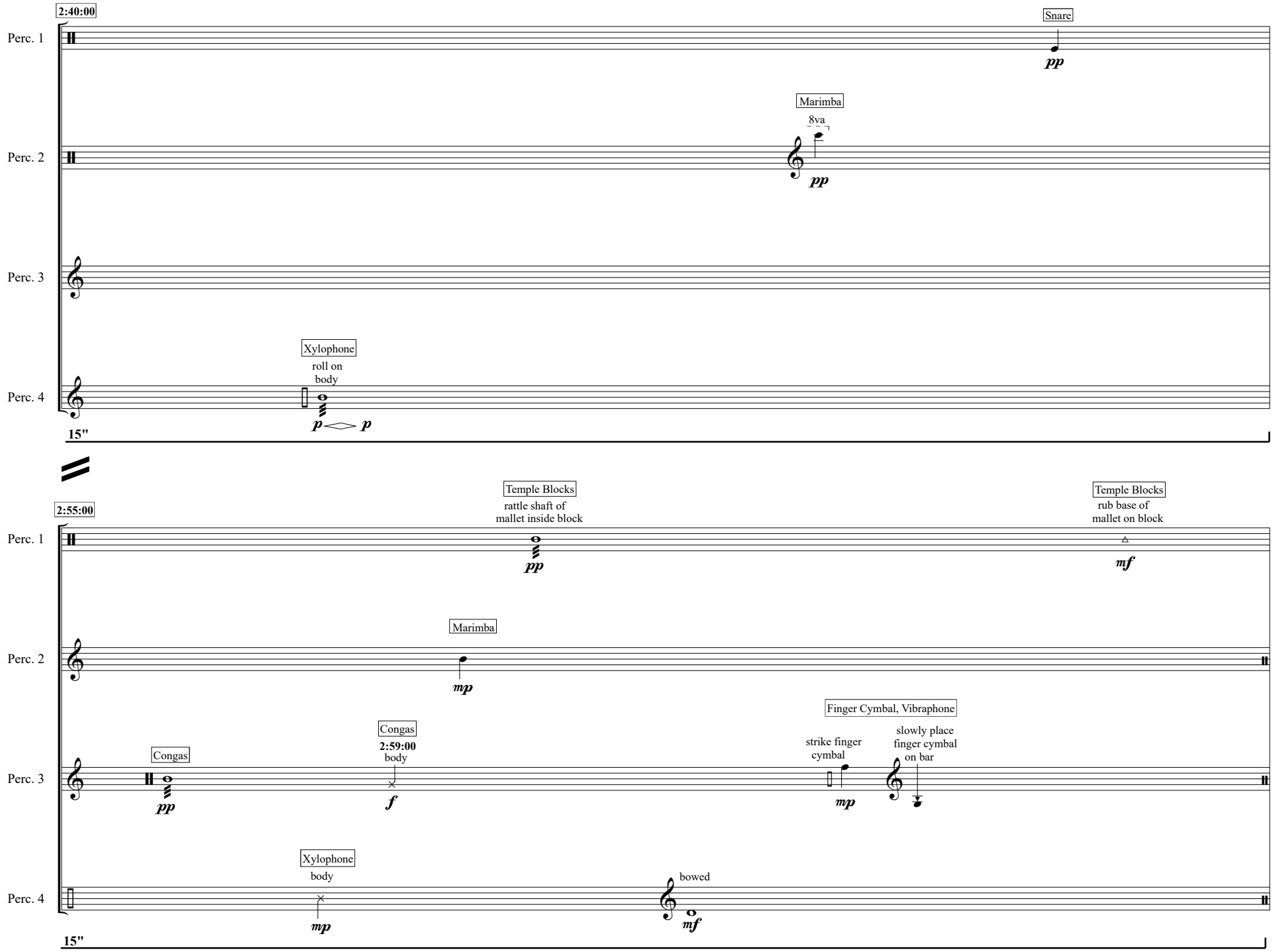
Buzzed

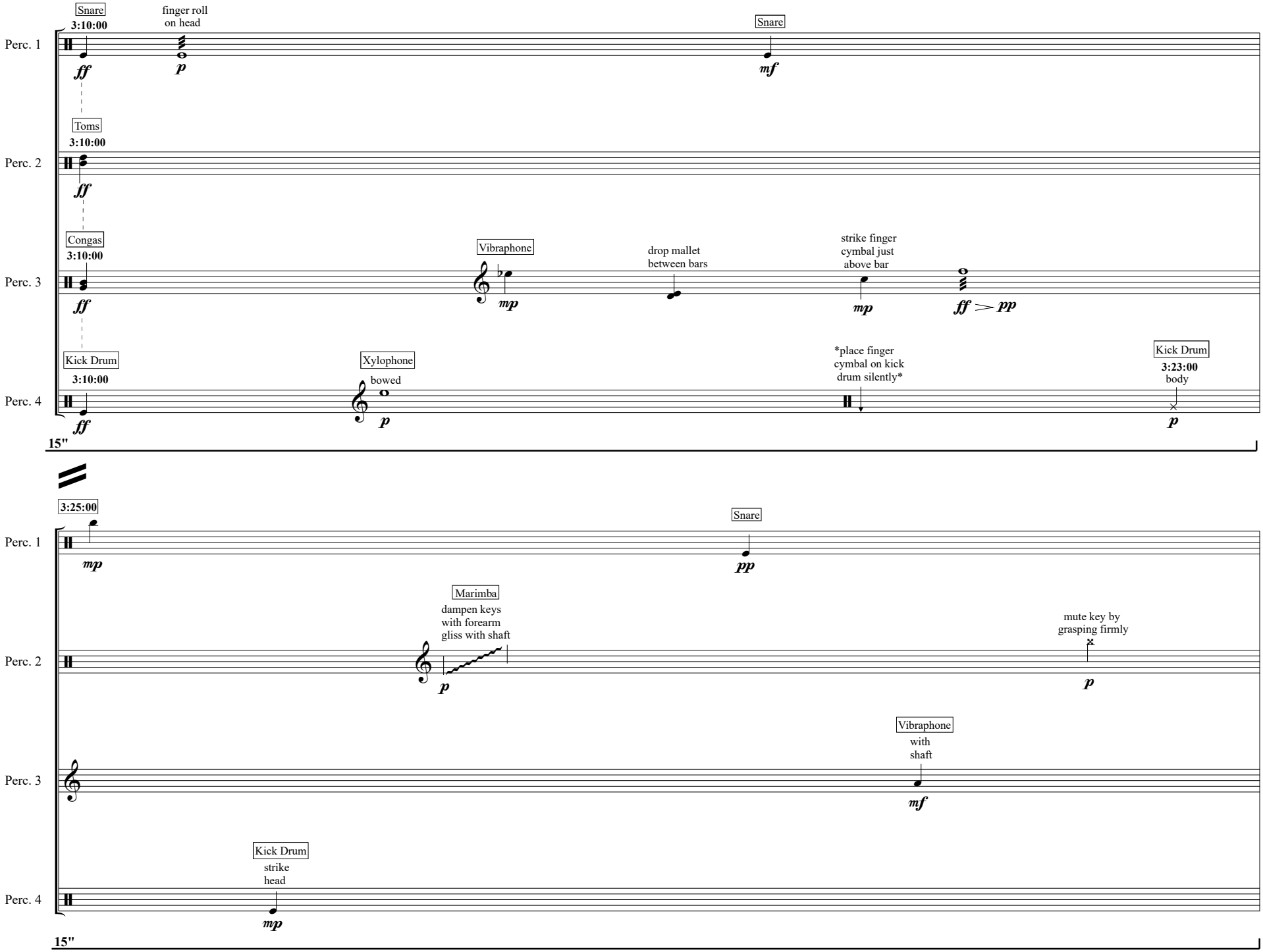

0:40:00
Steel Pan
body
Perc. 1
pp
Tom 2
0:49:00
body
Perc. 2
mp
Vibraphone
with
shaft
Perc. 3
mp
Kick Drum
0:44:00
body
Xylophone
roll on body
with shafts
Perc. 4
mf
p < f
15"
0:55:00
Steel Pan
body
Perc. 1
p
p
Tam-tam
Perc. 2
f
Perc. 3
Xylophone
mute key with mallet
strike shaft of mallet
Perc. 4
mf
15"

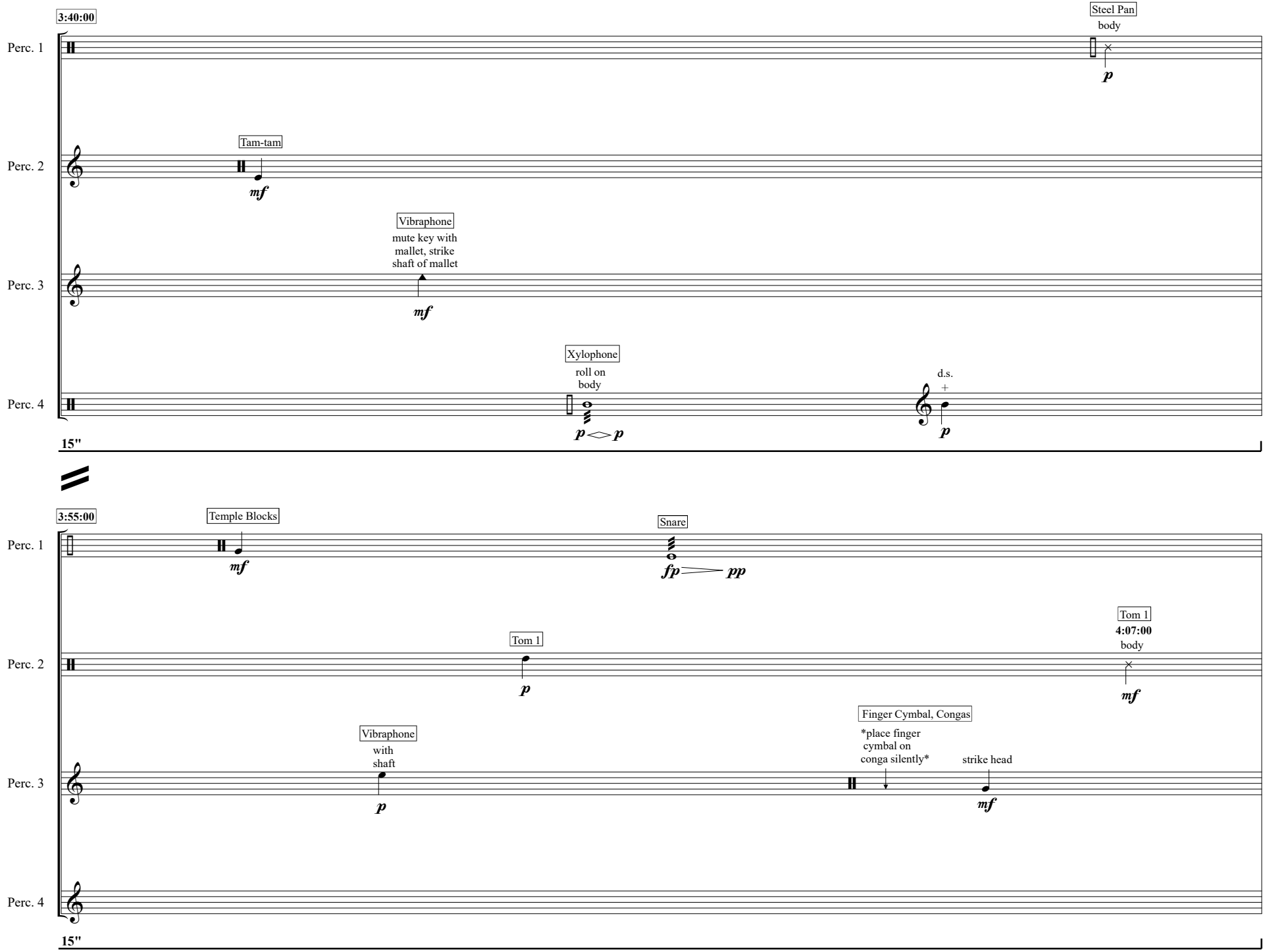

1:10:00
Steel Pan
Perc. 1
p
Marimba
8va
Perc. 2
mp
Vibraphone
Congas
Perc. 3
ff
pp
Kick Drum
Perc. 4
p
ff
15"
1:25:00
Finger Cymbal, Snare
place finger cymbal on snare silently
strike finger cymbal
Perc. 1
mp
Perc. 2
Congas
1:37:00
body
Perc. 3
pp
Perc. 4
15"

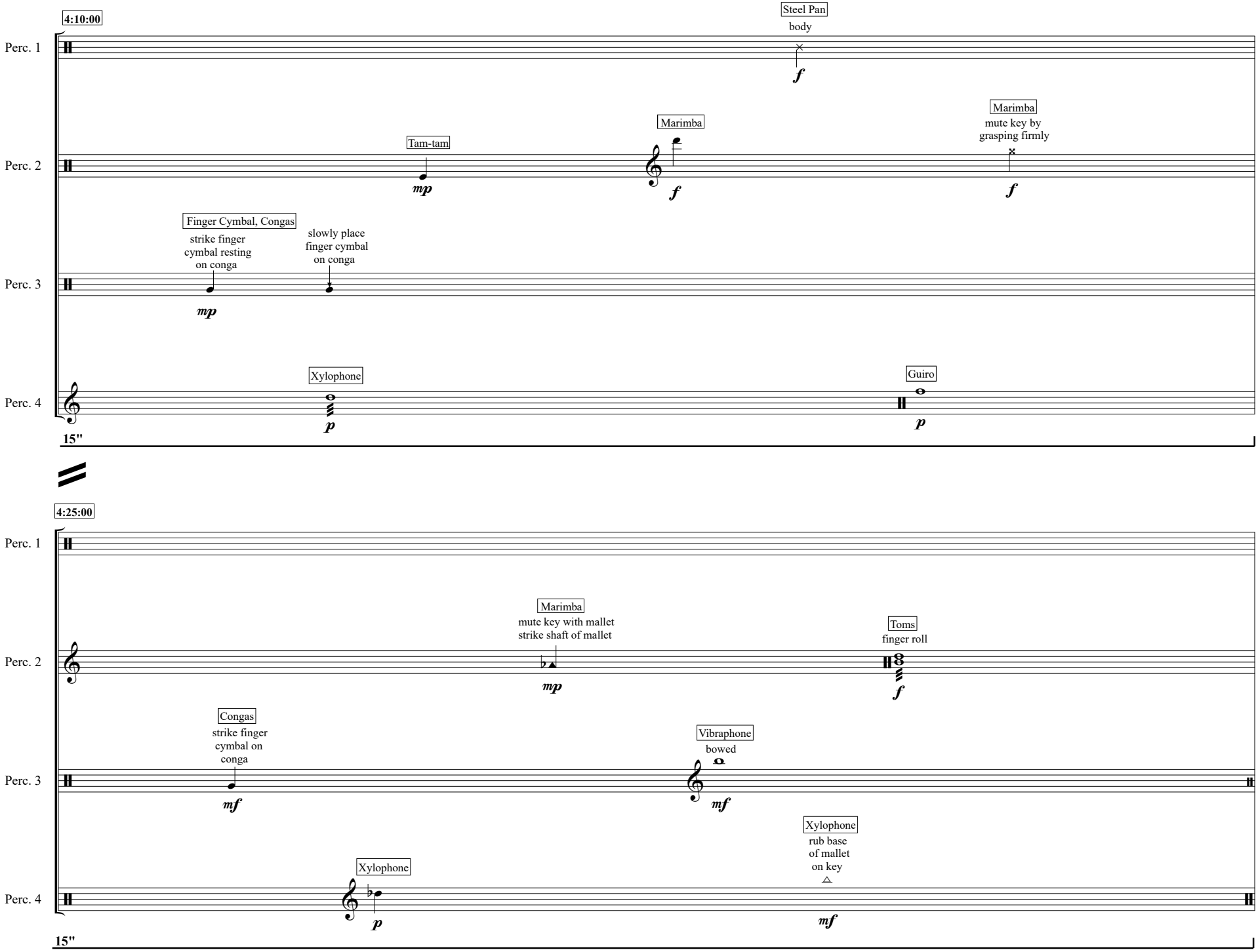
1:40:00
Temple Blocks
rattle shaft of
mallet inside block
ff
Perc. 1
Marimba
drop mallet
between keys
Perc. 2
Vibraphone
ff
fp
pp
Perc. 3
Perc. 4
15"
1:55:00
Perc. 1
Marimba
d.s.
+
mp
dampen keys
with forearm
gliss with shaft
pp
Perc. 2
Perc. 3
Xylophone
with
shaft
p
Perc. 4
15"


2:10:00
Perc. 1
Snare
rub snares
with fingers
p
Snare
2:20:00
body
f
Perc. 2
Tom 2, Finger Cymbal
strike finger
cymbal resting
on tom
mf
slowly place
finger cymbal
on head
Perc. 3
Vibraphone
mute key by
grasping firmly
ff
Perc. 4
Xylophone
mute key with mallet
strike shaft of mallet
mf
15"
2:25:00
Perc. 1
Finger Cymbal, Snare
strike finger
cymbal
mp
*place finger
cymbal on
trap table*
Perc. 2
Tam-tam
with medium
mallets
pp
f
Perc. 3
Vibraphone
p
Perc. 4
15"

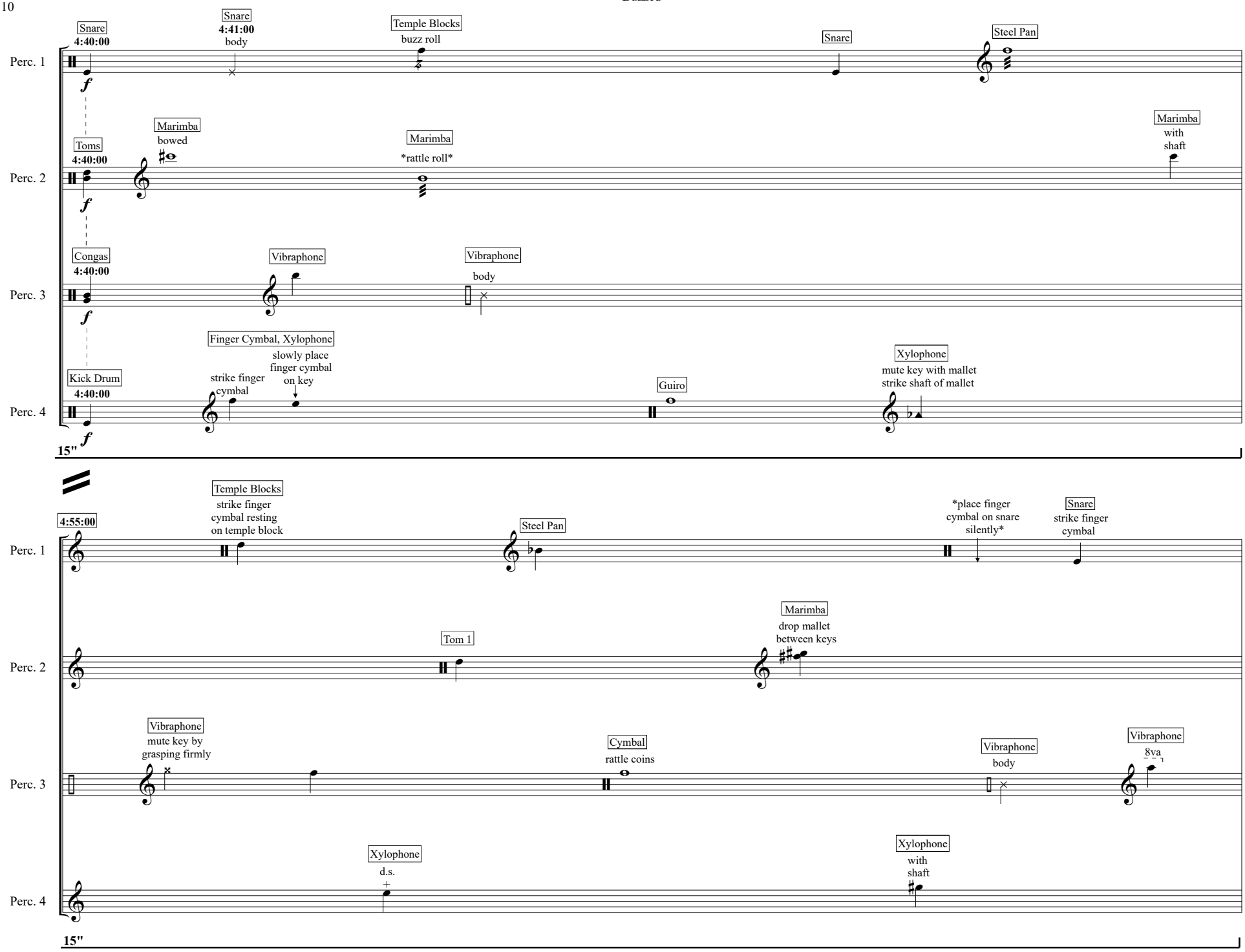

2:40:00
Perc. 1
Snare
pp
Perc. 2
Marimba
8va
pp
Perc. 3
Perc. 4
Xylophone
roll on
body
p
p
15"
2:55:00
Perc. 1
Temple Blocks
rattle shaft of
mallet inside block
pp
Temple Blocks
rub base of
mallet on block
mf
Perc. 2
Marimba
mp
Perc. 3
Congas
pp
Congas
2:59:00
body
f
Finger Cymbal, Vibraphone
strike finger
cymbal
mp
slowly place
finger cymbal
on bar
Perc. 4
Xylophone
body
mp
bowed
mf
15"

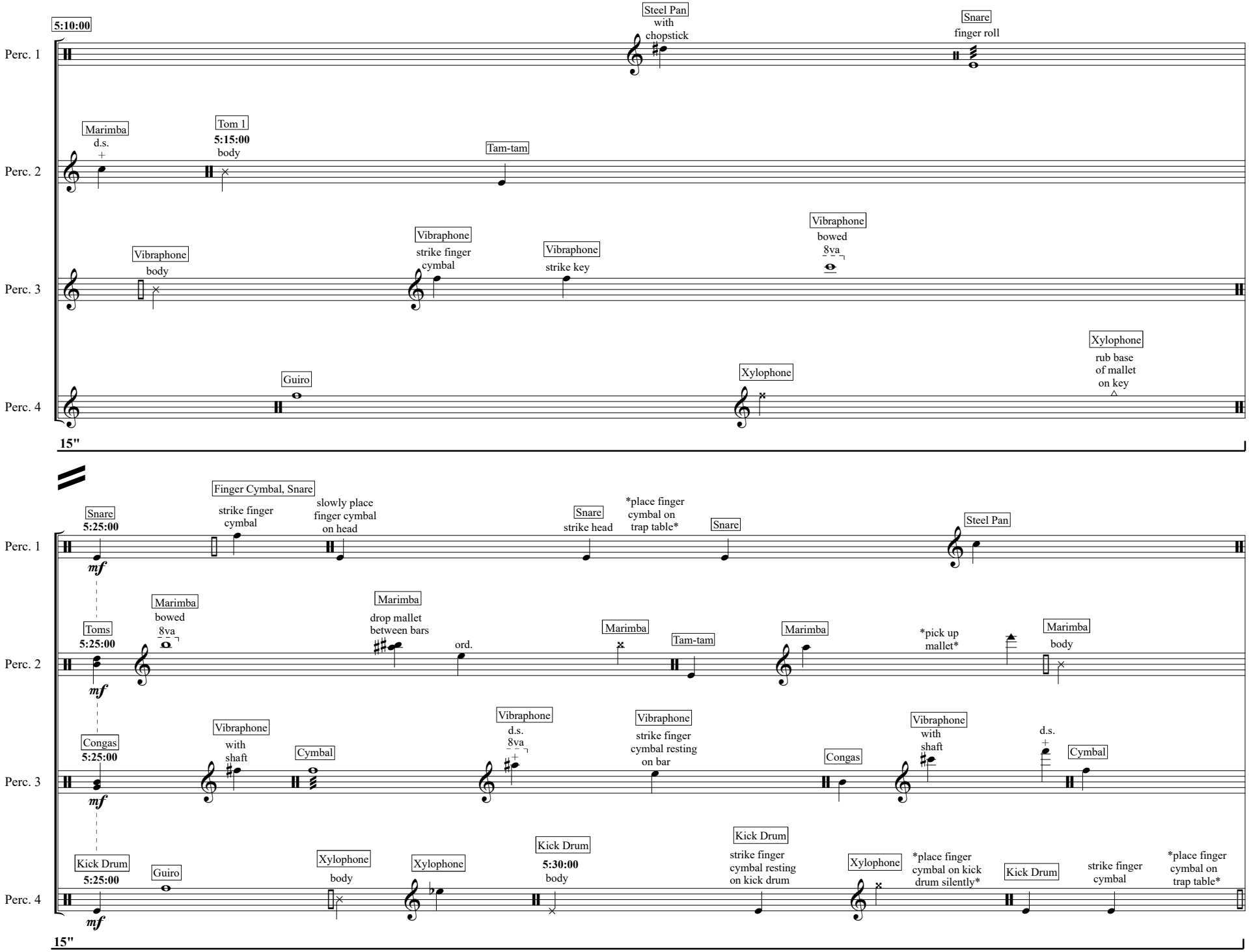

Snare
3:10:00
finger roll
on head
Snare
Perc. 1
ff
p
mf
Toms
3:10:00
Perc. 2
ff
Congas
3:10:00
Vibraphone
drop mallet
between bars
strike finger
cymbal just
above bar
Perc. 3
ff
mp
mp
ff > pp
Kick Drum
3:10:00
Xylophone
bowed
*place finger
cymbal on kick
drum silently*
Kick Drum
3:23:00
body
Perc. 4
ff
p
p
15"
3:25:00
Snare
Perc. 1
mp
pp
Marimba
dampen keys
with forearm
gliss with shaft
mute key by
grasping firmly
Perc. 2
p
p
Vibraphone
with
shaft
Perc. 3
mf
Kick Drum
strike
head
Perc. 4
mp
15"


3:40:00
Steel Pan
body
Perc. 1
p
Tam-tam
Perc. 2
mf
Vibraphone
mute key with
mallet, strike
shaft of mallet
Perc. 3
mf
Xylophone
roll on
body
d.s.
+
Perc. 4
p
p
p
15"
3:55:00
Temple Blocks
Snare
Perc. 1
mf
fp
pp
Tom 1
Tom 1
4:07:00
body
Perc. 2
p
mf
Finger Cymbal, Congas
*place finger
cymbal on
conga silently*
strike head
Vibraphone
with
shaft
Perc. 3
p
mf
Perc. 4
15"

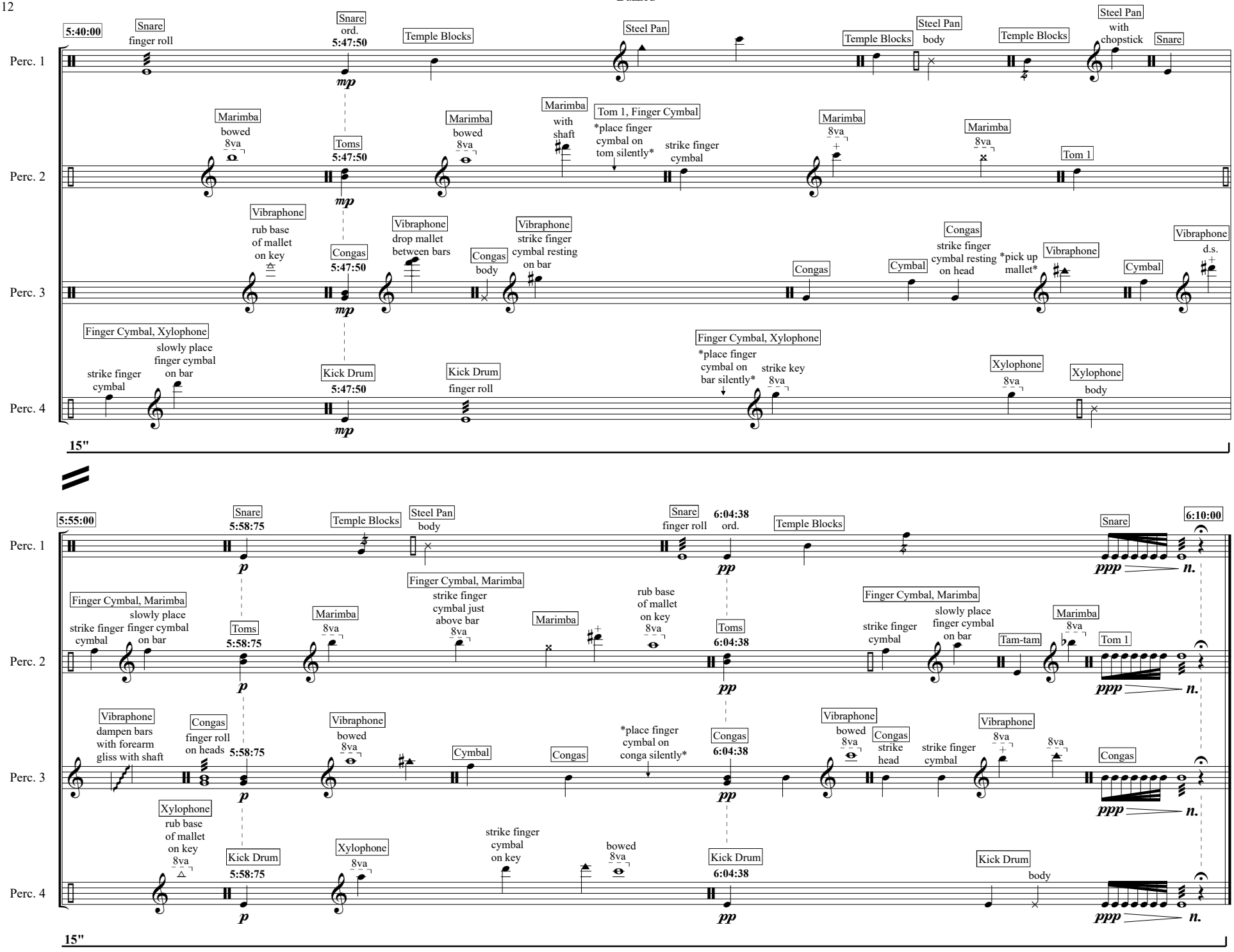

4:10:00
Perc. 1
Steel Pan
body
f
Perc. 2
Tam-tam
mp
Marimba
f
Marimba
mute key by
grasping firmly
f
Perc. 3
Finger Cymbal, Congas
strike finger
cymbal resting
on conga
mp
slowly place
finger cymbal
on conga
Perc. 4
Xylophone
p
Guiro
p
15"
4:25:00
Perc. 1
Perc. 2
Marimba
mute key with mallet
strike shaft of mallet
mp
Toms
finger roll
f
Perc. 3
Congas
strike finger
cymbal on
conga
mf
Vibraphone
bowed
mf
Perc. 4
Xylophone
p
Xylophone
rub base
of mallet
on key
mf
15"

Buzzed


Perc. 1
Perc. 2
Perc. 3
Perc. 4
Snare
4:40:00
Snare
4:41:00
body
Temple Blocks
buzz roll
Snare
Steel Pan
Toms
4:40:00
Marimba
bowed
Marimba
rattle roll
Marimba
with
shaft
Congas
4:40:00
Vibraphone
Vibraphone
body
Kick Drum
4:40:00
Finger Cymbal, Xylophone
strike finger
cymbal
slowly place
finger cymbal
on key
Guiro
Xylophone
mute key with mallet
strike shaft of mallet
15"
4:55:00
Temple Blocks
strike finger
cymbal resting
on temple block
Steel Pan
*place finger
cymbal on snare
silently*
Snare
strike finger
cymbal
Tom 1
Marimba
drop mallet
between keys
Vibraphone
mute key by
grasping firmly
Cymbal
rattle coins
Vibraphone
body
Vibraphone
8va
Xylophone
d.s.
Xylophone
with
shaft
15"


5:10:00
Perc. 1
Steel Pan
with
chopstick
Snare
finger roll
Perc. 2
Marimba
d.s.
Tom 1
5:15:00
body
Tam-tam
Perc. 3
Vibraphone
body
Vibraphone
strike finger
cymbal
Vibraphone
strike key
Vibraphone
bowed
8va
Perc. 4
Guiro
Xylophone
Xylophone
rub base
of mallet
on key
15"
Perc. 1
Snare
5:25:00
mf
Finger Cymbal, Snare
strike finger
cymbal
slowly place
finger cymbal
on head
Snare
strike head
*place finger
cymbal on
trap table*
Snare
Steel Pan
Perc. 2
Toms
5:25:00
mf
Marimba
bowed
8va
Marimba
drop mallet
between bars
ord.
Marimba
Tam-tam
Marimba
*pick up
mallet*
Marimba
body
Perc. 3
Congas
5:25:00
mf
Vibraphone
with
shaft
Cymbal
Vibraphone
d.s.
8va
Vibraphone
strike finger
cymbal resting
on bar
Congas
Vibraphone
with
shaft
d.s.
Cymbal
Perc. 4
Kick Drum
5:25:00
mf
Guiro
Xylophone
body
Xylophone
Kick Drum
5:30:00
body
Kick Drum
strike finger
cymbal resting
on kick drum
Xylophone
*place finger
cymbal on kick
drum silently*
Kick Drum
strike finger
cymbal
*place finger
cymbal on
trap table*
15"

Buzzed


5:40:00
Perc. 1
Snare
finger roll
Snare
ord.
5:47:50
mp
Temple Blocks
Steel Pan
Temple Blocks
Steel Pan
body
Temple Blocks
Steel Pan
with
chopstick
Snare
Perc. 2
Marimba
bowed
8va
Toms
5:47:50
mp
Marimba
bowed
8va
Marimba
with
shaft
Tom 1, Finger Cymbal
*place finger
cymbal on
tom silently*
strike finger
cymbal
Marimba
8va
Marimba
8va
Tom 1
Perc. 3
Vibraphone
rub base
of mallet
on key
Congas
5:47:50
mp
Vibraphone
drop mallet
between bars
Congas
body
Vibraphone
strike finger
cymbal resting
on bar
Congas
Cymbal
Congas
strike finger
cymbal resting
on head
*pick up
mallet*
Vibraphone
Cymbal
Vibraphone
d.s.
Perc. 4
Finger Cymbal, Xylophone
strike finger
cymbal
slowly place
finger cymbal
on bar
Kick Drum
5:47:50
mp
Kick Drum
finger roll
Finger Cymbal, Xylophone
*place finger
cymbal on
bar silently*
strike key
8va
Xylophone
8va
Xylophone
body
15"
5:55:00
Perc. 1
Snare
5:58:75
p
Temple Blocks
Steel Pan
body
Snare
finger roll
6:04:38
ord.
pp
Temple Blocks
Snare
ppp
n.
6:10:00
Perc. 2
Finger Cymbal, Marimba
strike finger
cymbal
slowly place
finger cymbal
on bar
Toms
5:58:75
p
Marimba
8va
Finger Cymbal, Marimba
strike finger
cymbal just
above bar
8va
Marimba
rub base
of mallet
on key
8va
Toms
6:04:38
pp
Finger Cymbal, Marimba
strike finger
cymbal
slowly place
finger cymbal
on bar
Tam-tam
Marimba
8va
Tom 1
ppp
n.
Perc. 3
Vibraphone
dampen bars
with forearm
gliss with shaft
Congas
finger roll
on heads
5:58:75
p
Vibraphone
bowed
8va
Cymbal
Congas
*place finger
cymbal on
conga silently*
Congas
6:04:38
pp
Vibraphone
bowed
8va
Congas
strike
head
strike finger
cymbal
Vibraphone
8va
8va
Congas
ppp
n.
Perc. 4
Xylophone
rub base
of mallet
on key
8va
Kick Drum
5:58:75
p
Xylophone
8va
strike finger
cymbal
on key
bowed
8va
Kick Drum
6:04:38
pp
Kick Drum
body
ppp
n.
15"